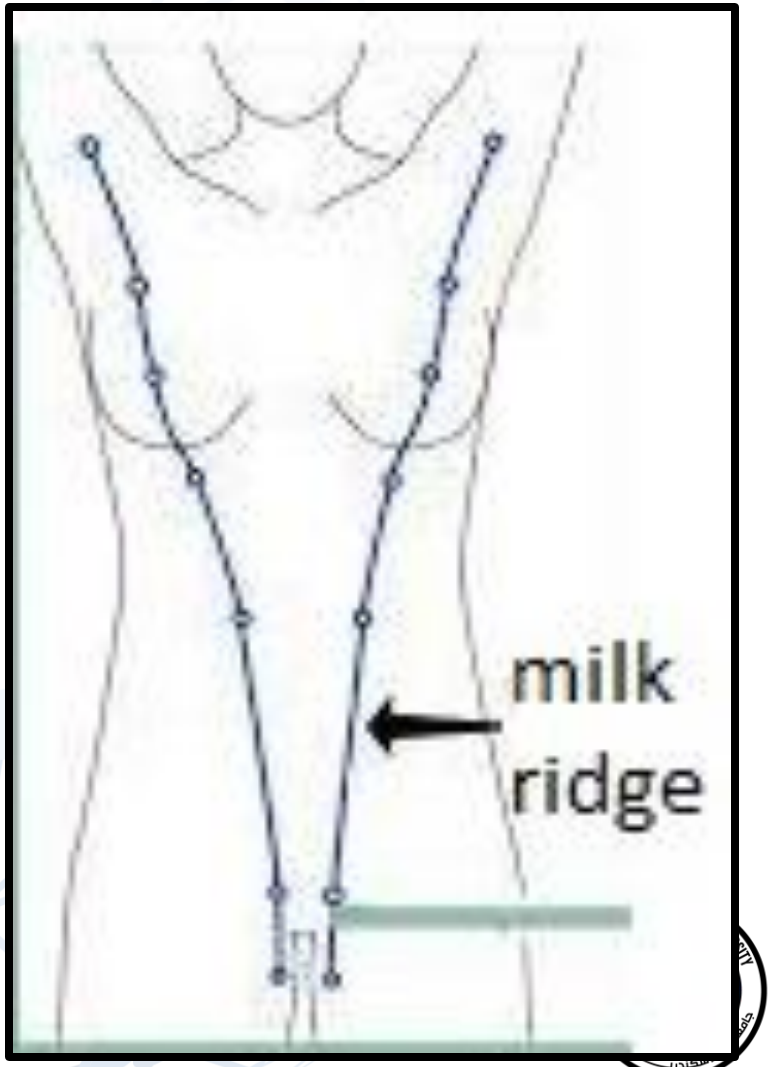
Development of the mammary glands

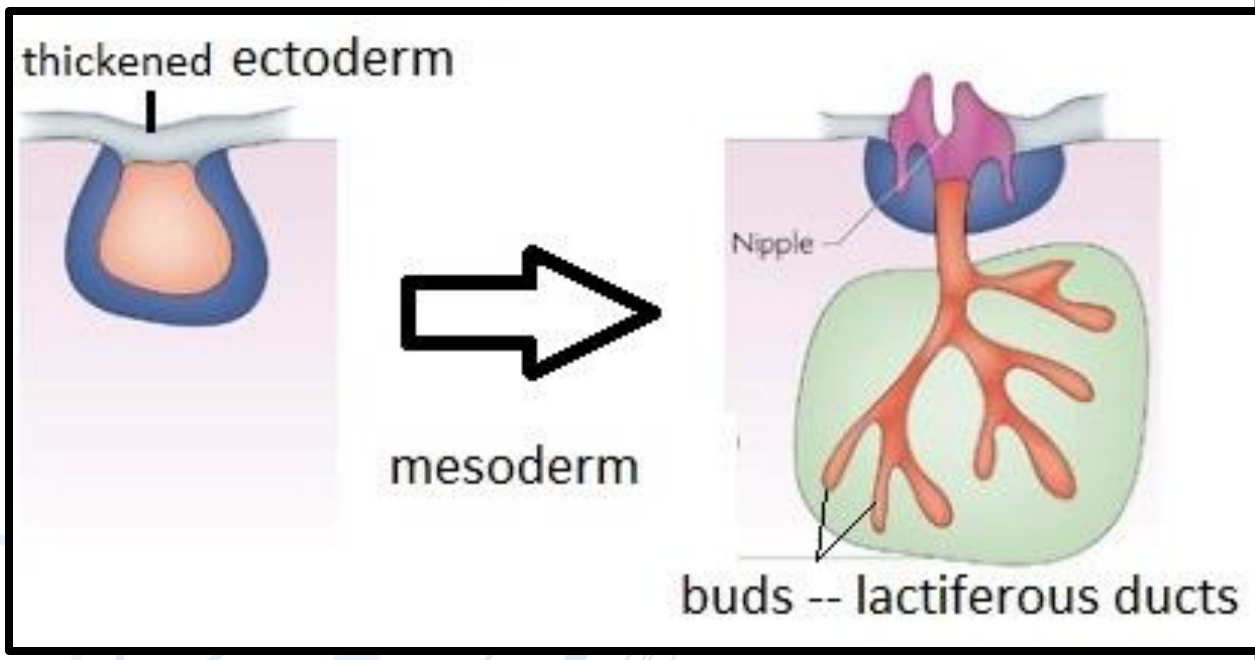
The milk ridge develops on each side as a thickening of the ectoderm extending from the axilla till the inguinal region.



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Development of the mammary glands

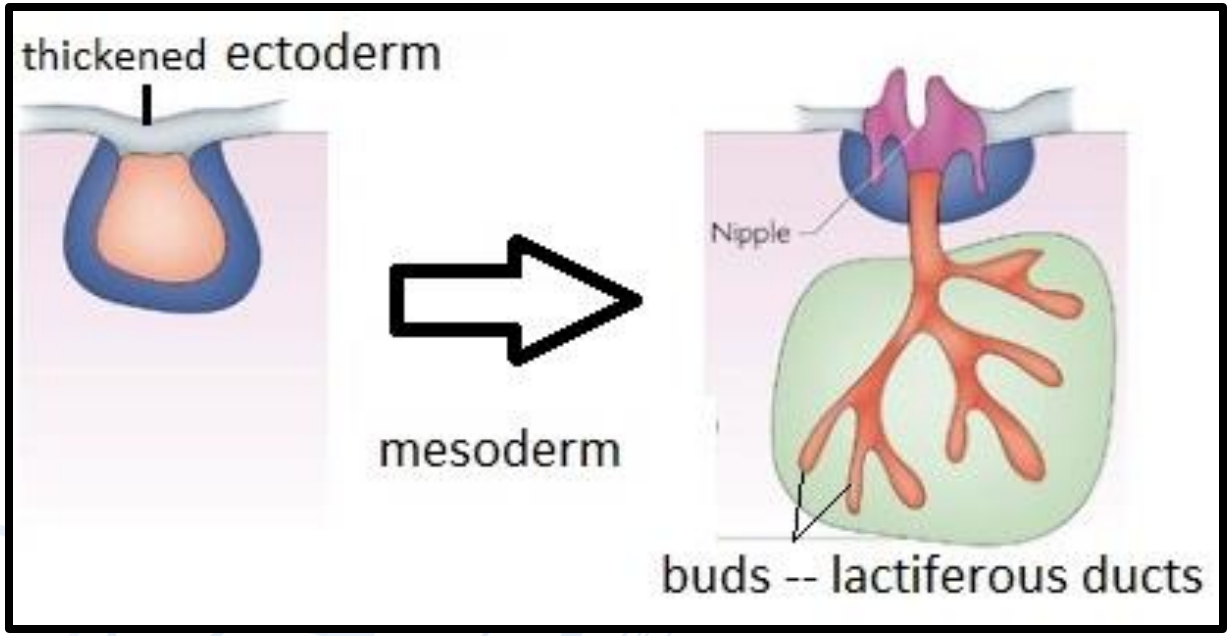
- In mammals, several mammary glands are formed along this ridge.
- In humans, the milk ridge disappears except at the pectoral region where a thickened depressed area persists that sends 15-20 buds that give smaller branches into the underlying mesoderm.
- Canalization of these buds occurs and lactiferous ducts are forms.
- Branches of the ducts form smaller ducts and alveoli of the mammary gland.
- Lactiferous ducts open in the depressed area which will be the future nipple.



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Development of the mammary glands

- The area around the nipple becomes dark forming the areola.
- In the neonates, the nipple is depressed but soon after birth, they become elevated due to proliferation of the underlying mesoderm.
- The fat of the mammary gland develops from the mesoderm.
- The mammary gland develops the same in both sexes, but in females development of the duct system and deposition of fat is due to the female sex hormones.



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